treaties and opium down the throats of the Chinese, this being an illustration of the ‘growing arrogance and interference by the western Powers’.

More notable, perhaps, was Nehru’s chastisement of Japan, which ‘not only followed Europe in industrial methods’, but, at least with regard to China, ‘also in imperialist aggression’. Speaking of the wars between the two nations in the 1890s, Nehru writes that ‘no scruple had ever troubled Japan in the pursuit of her imperial policy. She grabbed openly, not caring even to cover her designs with a veil.’ He also judged Japan harshly with regard to the war with China that took place at the time of the book’s writing. Thus, when the aggressor met with resistance from Chinese nationalists, it ‘tried to break it by vast and horrible massacres from the air and other methods of unbelievable barbarity’. But, continued Nehru, ‘in this fiery ordeal a new nation was forged in China, and the old lethargy of the Chinese people dropped away from them … The sympathy of the people of India was naturally with the Chinese people, as it also was with the Spanish Republic, and in India and America and elsewhere great movements for the boycott of Japanese goods grew.’

The sympathy of this particular Indian manifested itself in a trip he made to China in August 1939. The visit was cut short by the outbreak of hostilities in Europe, which forced Nehru to come home to discuss with his nationalist colleagues the impact of the War on their movement. Even so, the two weeks he spent in China were, wrote Nehru, ‘memorable ones both personally for me and for the future relations of India and China. I found, to my joy, that my desire that China and India should draw ever closer to each other was fully reciprocated by China’s leaders … I returned to India an even greater admirer of China and the Chinese people than I had been previously, and I could not imagine that any adverse fate could break the spirit of these ancient people, who had grown so young again.’

Shortly after writing these words, Nehru was jailed by the British. While in prison for the next three years, he composed *The Discovery of India*, a brilliant and idiosyncratic work that mixes autobiography with history, and cultural analysis with political prophecy. One important strand